THE MORNING ROUTINE GUIDE

WIN THE MORNING. WIN THE DAY.

Simple actions to start the day on purpose, before the day starts on you. **Pick what fits your life and do it every day.**

Mark Davies
Founder, Zenith Fit

Structure beats motivation. Every single time.

START HERE

THE POINT OF A MORNING ROUTINE

Nobody needs a 5am cold plunge and a 2 hour routine. What we want is a morning you start **on purpose,** with a bit of momentum, so you're in charge of the day before it starts throwing things at you.

This guide gives you options. Pick what fits your life, your kids, your shifts, your commute. **The best routine is the one you'll actually do on a Tuesday when everything's gone wrong.**

THE ZENITH MORNING RULE

3 THINGS BEFORE YOU PROPERLY CHECK YOUR PHONE.

Hydrate

Water first, then coffee.

Light and move

Daylight on your face and a few minutes moving.

Plan

Your top priorities for the day.

PICK YOUR LENGTH

HOW LONG HAVE YOU GOT?

Pick the one you can stick to **every single day.** Start smaller than you think. You can always build up.

Minimum dose

5 MINUTES

Do this every day, even on chaos mornings.

- 300 to 500ml water
- Curtains open, daylight on your face
- 20 slow breaths
- One question: what's the ONE thing that makes today a win?

The sweet spot

15 MINUTES

Where most people land.

- 500ml water
- 5 minutes of daylight and movement, a walk or mobility
- Decide your first protein meal
- Your top 3 for the day

Full version

30 MINUTES

For the days you've got the time.

- Water, plus electrolytes if you train early
- 10 minute walk outside
- 5 minutes of mobility or breathing
- Protein breakfast, or plan it
- 10 minutes on your one key task before messages

Don't panic if you can't do the 30 yet. The 5 minute version done every day beats the 30 minute version done twice a month. Never miss twice applies here too.

THE MORNING MENU

BUILD YOUR OWN ROUTINE

Pick **one from each box.** Mix and match until it fits your mornings.

BODY FIRST

Tells your body you're awake and in control.

- 5 minute walk outside
- Mobility for hips, back and shoulders
- 10 squats and 10 press ups
- Stretch while the kettle boils
- 30 seconds cold at the end of your shower
- 2 minutes breathing through your nose

MIND FIRST

Quietens the noise and gives you direction.

- Write your top 3 tasks
- Finish this: today I'll be the kind of person who...
- 3 things you're grateful for
- 2 minute brain dump on paper
- Read 2 pages of a book

NUTRITION FIRST

Takes the decisions away for later, when you're busy and stressed.

- Plan your first protein meal
- Sort your lunch before anything else
- Pack snacks on purpose: fruit and yoghurt, a protein bar
- Fill your water bottle and keep it in sight

ENVIRONMENT FIRST

A clear space makes for a clear head.

- Make your bed
- Quick tidy of the kitchen sides
- Gym kit out and ready
- Window open for fresh air
- Clothes sorted for the day

THE PHONE RULE

YOUR MORNING, NOT THEIRS

Open your phone first thing and you start your day in everyone else's world. **Give yourself 30 minutes before social media.**

IF YOU HAVE TO CHECK IT

1. Messages only. No scrolling.
2. Set a 3 minute timer.
3. Phone down, straight into your routine.

THE 2 ANCHORS THAT CHANGE EVERYTHING

WAKE TIME

Keep it within an hour, weekends included where you can. Your body loves a rhythm, and it's the same rule that sorts your sleep.

MORNING LIGHT

Outside within 30 minutes of waking, for 5 to 10 minutes. It helps your energy, mood, cravings, focus, and your sleep later that night.

QUICK SOLUTIONS

NO TIME? DO THIS.

Mornings absolutely mental? Do this in the bathroom. **2 to 4 minutes, total.**

1. Drink water while you get ready.
2. 60 seconds of breathing. In through the nose, out slowly.
3. Decide your win for the day.
4. Confirm today's non negotiable: your steps, your workout or your protein.

YOUR MORNING NON NEGOTIABLE

Choose ONE. Only one. One non negotiable you actually do beats a perfect plan you never follow.

- Steps started early
- A 10 minute walk before work
- Protein at breakfast
- Water before coffee
- No phone until you're dressed
- Workout done before midday

TAKE ACTION

THE 7 DAY MORNING CHALLENGE

Add one thing a day for 7 days. **You'll feel calmer, more focused and more in control by the end of the week.**

1. **Day 1.**
   Water before coffee.
2. **Day 2.**
   Daylight within 30 minutes of waking.
3. **Day 3.**
   A 5 minute walk.
4. **Day 4.**
   Write your top 3 tasks.
5. **Day 5.**
   Plan your first protein meal.
6. **Day 6.**
   No social media for the first 30 minutes.
7. **Day 7.**
   Keep your favourite 3. That's your routine.

YOUR ROUTINE BUILDER

Fill it in and stick it somewhere you'll see it every morning.

My routine length: 5, 15 or 30 minutes

My wake time is

My first 3 actions are

My daily non negotiable is